

TrendStack Nigeria Playbook

03 - SME Sales Playbook

How to target, qualify, pitch, close and retain Nigerian SME campaign customers.

Operating principle

Do not build more software until paid demand and repeatable campaign operations are proven. Use WhatsApp, Sheets, simple forms, Drive and manual reporting first.

Document	Purpose	Use it when
03	A focused guide that separates strategy from execution so the founder and Nigeria team can act without information overload.	Use this as a working playbook. Review it weekly, mark what is done, and update based on paid campaign evidence.

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Inputs used: founder context, current TrendStack learnings, and the uploaded Growth Marketing Plan for Trendstack.

1. Who to sell to first

The best customer is not any SME. It is an SME with a product, social presence, budget and a clear action they want customers to take.

Customer signal	Why it matters
Product or service people can understand quickly	Creators need to explain it in short video content.
Existing Instagram, TikTok or WhatsApp sales activity	The business already believes in social marketing.
Ability to pay upfront	Interest without payment is not validation.
Clear campaign goal	Examples: WhatsApp enquiries, bookings, sales, app signups, event tickets, store visits.
Operational readiness	The business can respond to enquiries, fulfill orders and approve content quickly.
Willingness to share results	You need at least basic sales/leads feedback to prove value.

Avoid

Do not spend time on businesses that want free trials, guaranteed virality, magic results on tiny budgets, or campaigns with no clear call-to-action.

2. Vertical-specific sales angle

Each vertical should hear a message that connects creator activity to business value.

Vertical	Sales angle	Best package
Beauty/skincare/hair	Get beauty creators to create tutorials, routines, product reviews and unboxings that drive WhatsApp orders or page visits.	Growth Creator Sprint
Fashion/accessories	Get creators to style your items, post try-on videos and create reusable short-form content for your brand page.	Growth Creator Sprint
Restaurants/food/cafes	Get local food/lifestyle creators to feature your menu, ambience or offer and send people to your WhatsApp/reservation link.	Starter or Growth Sprint
Gyms/salons/spas	Get local lifestyle creators to show real customer experience, class visits, services, transformations or booking offers.	Starter Sprint
Consumer startups	Use creator-led campaigns with tracked links/codes to drive signups, downloads, waitlist entries or referrals.	Growth Sprint

3. Campaign packages to sell

Keep the pricing menu short so the sales team does not confuse the customer.

Package	Best for	Deliverables	Price range
Starter Visibility Sprint	Small brand testing creators for the first time.	3-5 creators; 3-5 videos; basic brief; review; posting; basic report.	NGN 200k-350k
Growth Creator Sprint	Main package for serious SMEs.	8-10 creators; stronger brief; matching; review; tracking; final report; next campaign plan.	NGN 500k-900k
Monthly Creator Retainer	Brands that want consistent creator visibility.	Campaign waves across the month; content library; reporting; creator ranking.	NGN 750k-1.5 m/month

Payment rule: collect upfront payment or a firm deposit before creator work starts. Do not allow sales reps to collect cash personally.

4. Sales process

Every opportunity should move through the same stages.

Stage	What happens	Required action
1. Lead found	Business discovered through event, Instagram, LinkedIn, referral, website form or QR signup.	Add to lead tracker.
2. Qualified	Check industry, decision maker, budget, social presence, need and likely timing.	Mark as qualified or unqualified.
3. Discovery	Ask goals, target customer, current marketing, campaign budget and desired action.	Recommend one package.
4. Proposal	Send short proposal with objective, creators, timeline, deliverables, price and payment terms.	Follow up within 24 hours.
5. Closed	Payment received and campaign start date agreed.	Handoff to campaign ops.
6. Repeat	After final report, pitch the next campaign based on learnings.	Book next wave.

5. Outreach scripts

Use these as starting points. The team should adapt them to the specific business.

WhatsApp / Instagram DM for beauty, fashion or food business

Message

Hi [Name], I am with TrendStack. We help Nigerian SMEs run affordable campaigns with vetted nano and micro creators. We handle the creator selection, brief, content review, posting and final report so you do not have to chase influencers manually. I saw your [product/page] and think a small creator sprint could work well. Are you open to a quick call this week?

Follow-up after no reply

Message

Just following up. The campaign does not need to be large. We can start with 3-5 vetted creators, content approval before posting, and a simple report showing posts, engagement, enquiries and what worked. Should I send a sample package?

Phone opener

Message

We are not selling random influencer shoutouts. We manage the campaign end to end: creator matching, content brief, review, posting proof and reporting. The goal is to help your business test creator marketing without the usual influencer stress.

6. Discovery questions

Ask enough to understand the campaign, but do not turn the call into an interrogation.

- What product, service or offer do you want to promote?
- Who exactly is your target customer?
- Which city or audience location matters most?
- What action do you want people to take: WhatsApp, order, booking, signup, store visit or follow?
- Have you used influencers or creators before? What worked and what failed?
- What is your current monthly marketing spend?
- Do you have product samples, photos, videos or landing pages ready?
- How quickly can you approve creator content?
- Can you track coupon codes, WhatsApp enquiries, bookings or sales from the campaign?
- Would you prefer a small test or a stronger 8-10 creator sprint?

Qualification rule

If the customer cannot define a target audience, campaign goal or budget, move slowly. They may consume time but not convert.

7. Objection handling

The sales team should respond with confidence but never overpromise.

Objection	Response
"Can we try it for free?"	We do not run free campaigns because creators must be paid and properly managed. We can start with a small Starter Sprint to reduce risk.
"Can you guarantee sales?"	No honest campaign partner can guarantee sales. We guarantee managed creator delivery, content review, posting proof, tracking and reporting.
"Why not just DM influencers myself?"	You can, but TrendStack saves you sourcing, negotiation, briefing, chasing, review, payment coordination and reporting.
"Your price is high."	The price includes multiple creators, campaign management, review, coordination, reporting and creator payouts. A cheaper campaign usually means less control.
"We only want big influencers."	For SMEs, nano/micro creators often give more targeted community trust and better affordability. Big influencers can be added later when the campaign is proven.
"Will this go viral?"	The goal is not to promise virality. The goal is to create quality creator content, local visibility, enquiries and campaign learnings.

8. On-ground team model and KPIs

Start small. Scale the team only after the sales process works.

Role	Responsibilities	KPIs
Business development lead	Find leads, qualify prospects, run calls, send proposals, close paid campaigns.	Qualified leads, calls, proposals, paid campaigns, revenue, repeat bookings.
Creator/campaign ops lead	Maintain creator bench, match creators, chase submissions, coordinate approvals and payouts.	Creator reliability, on-time submissions, approved content rate, campaign completion rate.
Founder/strategy lead	Set pricing, approve proposals, protect quality, review reports and decide what to automate.	Margin, repeat customers, customer feedback, strategic focus.

Sales KPI warning: do not reward random leads. Reward qualified conversations, proposals, paid campaigns and repeat bookings.

9. Lead tracker and case study fields

Use one simple source of truth for every prospect and every campaign.

Lead tracker fields

Field 1	Field 2	Field 3	Field 4	Field 5	Field 6
Business name	Industry	Contact person	WhatsApp/phone	Instagram/TikTok	City
Lead source	Campaign goal	Budget range	Decision maker?	Stage	Next step/date
Package recommended	Proposal sent?	Payment status	Campaign status	Owner	Notes

Case study fields after campaign

- [] Customer category and campaign goal.
- [] Number of creators and content pieces.
- [] Best content angle and best creator.
- [] Views, engagement, clicks, coupon usage, enquiries or sales signals.
- [] Customer quote or feedback.
- [] What TrendStack recommended for the next campaign.